Slow Down:
In the Moment

Campbell Smith

Aim

My aim with my concepts is to allow people to exist in the moment with limited digital distractions, giving them a way to focus on themselves, and the world around them, rather than the digital world.

Personally, a large part of my time is spent walking and hiking, specifically as a dog walker, within this practice a large part of the time I find my attention and mindfulness I stolen by having to log onto my phone to write up walk reports for the dog's owner, which typically spirals into the checking of texts, and emails.

Through my research I developed an interest in mediation and mindfulness as a way to increase a persons motivation and attention.

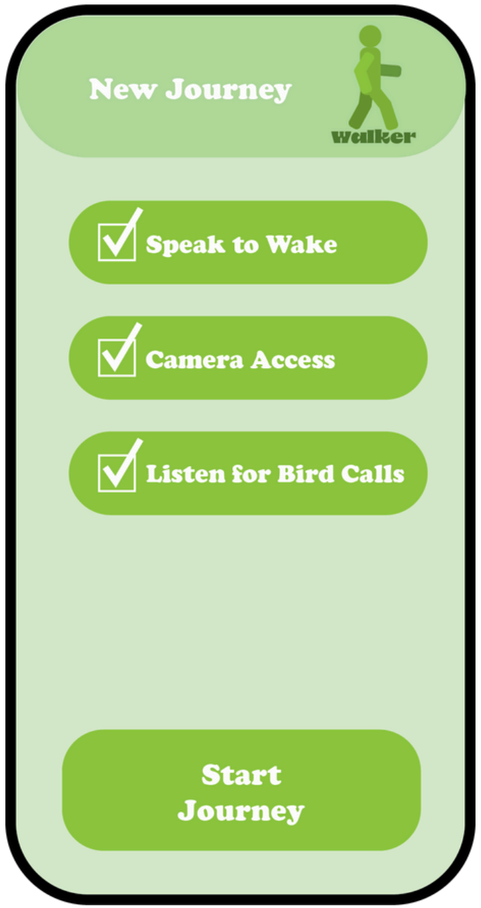
Techniques seen in meditation practices, such as grounding, and breathing work have shown to improve stress levels, and retrain an individuals attention.

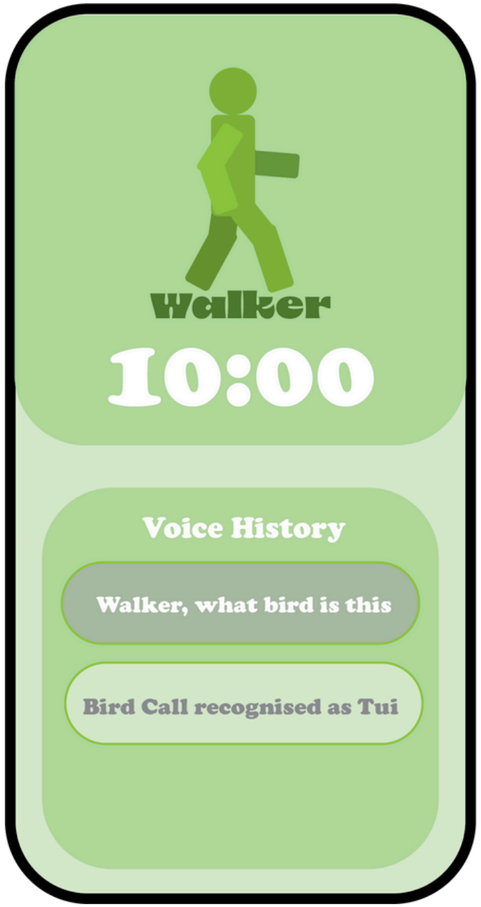
Walker

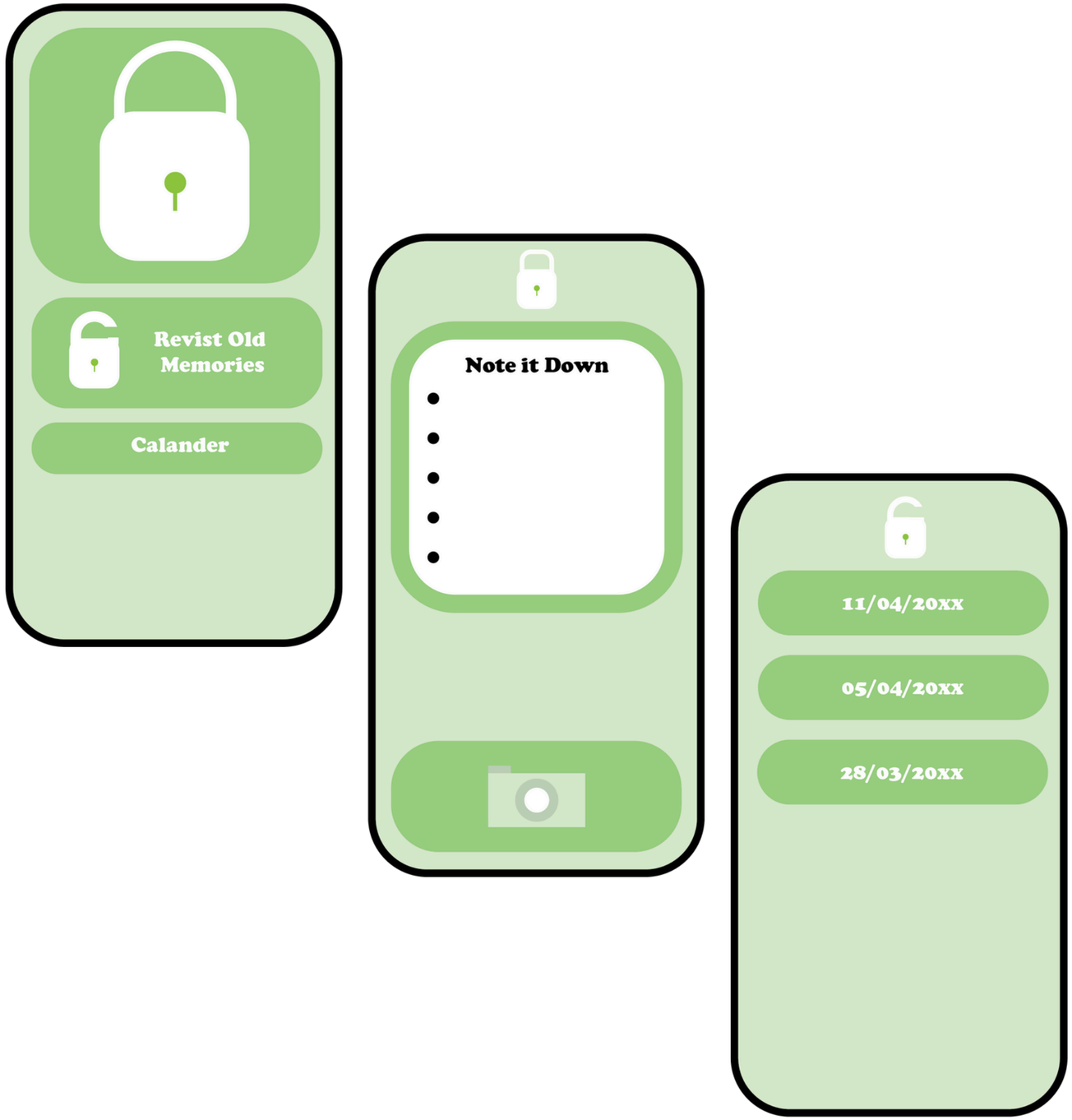
Walker is an app that ‘bricks’ the users phone to allow them to focus on the journey.

- Users can use their phone only with voice, which takes away the anti-social screen aspects of phone use whilst walking and hiking,
  - This voice use allows users to still send messages, google, and take photos. All without needing to unlock your phone.
- A key characteristic of the app would be it’s bird call feature, recording a video automatically when it hears native bird song so users can identify the call later.









Lock it Up

Lock it up is another app system, with a focus on locking away notes, and photographs till the user's current event is over.

- Often phone usage takes people out of the moment, the lock it up app reduces task switching which allows users to focus on the moment then.
  - This is done through it's note taking tool and camera.
  - The note taking tool allows users to note down thoughts as they come without allowing them to get side tracked by these thoughts, this is done by locking away the thought and prompting them later when their calander event is done.
  - The camera works similairly, but more like a film camera, not showing the user the photos they've taken till after the calander event.

Adventure Buddies

Adventure buddies is a system inspired by Nintendo's 3Ds street pass.
Adventure buddies are little keychain avatars that look like the user, when walking around with the buddy connected to their phone they can wirelessly connect to any buddies they pass.

- Once the user has disconnected the buddy, idealy when they get home to not miss any new buddies, anyone they crossed paths with will be added to their buddy list.
    - This encourages the user to not focus on the game, and instead on getting out and collecting more friends.
- The more buddies collected the more mini games the user unlocks.
    - Mini games would function as basic puzzle games, increasing in difficulty with the buddies met.
    - Each mini game would feature the buddies predominately.





